

[00:01] Interviewer: "Hello, thanks for your time. I'm Anita Rahman, a student of Ravensbourne University. I'm currently working with HiveMind to improve workspace onboarding and how people find information at work. I'm here to learn from your experience. With your permission, I would like to record our conversation. The interview will take roughly 30-40 minutes."

[00:15] Interviewer: What is your current job role?

[00:18] P01: "I am the Managing Director of a garment manufacturing company based in Dhaka."

[00:21] Interviewer: What industry is your company in?

[00:35] P01: "It's not directly under a singular company. It's like I produce garments using the resources that I have to meet the needs of the buyer. Then those buyers do their work, like putting labels or a logo, to send these garments abroad."

[00:44] Interviewer: Roughly how big is the company?

[00:52] P01: "I have around 150 employees under my command across our factory and merchandising department."

[01:15] Interviewer: Think about the first days of your work look like?

[01:35] P01: "When I first started to work in this industry, I was an entry-level worker. I was paid daily based on the work I did. It was quite hard, but I slowly made my way up."

[02:15] Interviewer: Can you please tell me more about what part was most difficult?

[02:35] P01: "Since I was paid based on how many pieces of knitted products I did, I always tried to do more so I could be paid. So, I didn't pay that much attention to my health and often worked overtime without sleeping. But slowly I learned a disciplined life since my whole family relied on me."

[03:45] Interviewer: In the first two weeks, what were the top 3 things you needed to know to do your job well?

[04:05] P01: "Firstly, I needed to know how our machine works, secondly how the production line communicates with merchandising. Thirdly, who the key buyers were and their specific requirements."

[05:15] Interviewer: What was the hardest part of getting started? Why?

[05:35] P01: "Understanding the informal relationships was especially hard. Unlike the first world countries, our country does things in a different way. So I had to learn about who actually makes decisions versus who is officially responsible, as that was never written down anywhere."

[07:00] Interviewer: Why was that difficult?

[07:20] P01: "Because if something goes wrong in the huge order of garments, we often don't know who to hold responsible. Although it happens rarely for the whole order to go wrong, it brings in huge loss for our production crew."

[08:30] Interviewer: When you need an answer at work, where do you go first?

[08:50] P01: "Usually I call the executives of the relevant department directly. Here most of us do phone calls instead of e-mails because our work isn't heavily dependent on computers. Here, a lot of factory communication happens informally."

[10:15] Interviewer: How do you manage that many people?

[10:35] P01: "Working in factories where working hours isn't a thing might be shocking to some people. I have to use 2 phones to receive all the important calls and information. When it comes to completing a big order, it gets really frustrating sometimes because even minor incidents require me."

[12:00] Interviewer: Tell me about a time you couldn't find something important. What happened?

[12:20] P01: "Once during a buyer audit, I couldn't quickly locate an updated compliance certificate. It was saved on someone's personal laptop instead of a shared drive, and it delayed the audit meeting by almost 2 hours."

[13:45] Interviewer: How do you personally keep track of important links, documents or tasks? What's great or not great about your method?

[14:05] P01: "I keep a physical notebook and also forward important emails to myself. It's not efficient; things get buried, and I sometimes forget where I saved something. But the great part about my method is that I memorised almost everyone's phone number that's relevant to my work field. I think I might be somewhat good with numbers."

[15:45] Interviewer: What information should be reachable within just a few clicks?

[16:00] P01: "Compliance and audit documents, and contact details for department heads and key buyers."

[16:45] Interviewer: When you find a document or answer, how do you know it's correct or up to date?

[17:00] P01: "Honestly, most of the time I have to call someone to confirm. There's no clear version control."

[17:45] Interviewer: On your first day, what would have made you feel less lost?

[18:00] P01: "A simple guide showing who does what, and a clear list of priorities for the first week."

[18:45] Interviewer: In your first week, did you clearly know what to do next each day? If not, what was missing?

[19:00] P01: "No, not clearly. I had to ask around constantly to figure out what needed my attention each day."

[19:45] Interviewer: What makes onboarding feel personal and useful rather than generic?

[20:05] P01: "If it's specific to my actual role and department, not just general company policy. For example, showing me exactly which buyers and production lines I'm responsible for."

[21:00] Interviewer: What made you feel "I'm doing okay" or "I'm on track"?

[21:20] P01: "Positive feedback from the board and seeing that production targets were being met. I wish there had been more regular check-ins early on, rather than only being judged at the end of the month."

[22:15] Interviewer: When you needed help, did you know who to ask and how to get it quickly?

[22:35] P01: "Eventually yes, but it took time to learn the informal hierarchy. There was no clear directory of "ask this person for this issue.""

[23:30] Interviewer: Have you used AI tools at work? What was good or bad about it?

[23:50] P01: "We've started using some software with AI features for production forecasting. It's useful for spotting patterns, but I don't fully trust it without checking the numbers myself."

[24:45] Interviewer: What would make you not trust it?

[25:00] P01: "It's just I still didn't fully understand its concept."

[26:00] Interviewer: What kinds of workplace questions should an AI tool answer with "You should ask a human"?

[26:20] P01: "Anything about employee grievances, disciplinary issues, or sensitive buyer negotiations. Those need a human's judgment."

[27:30] Interviewer: What were the top 2 problems you mentioned today?

[27:50] P01: "Information scattered across too many places, and no clear onboarding structure when someone joins or moves into a new role."

[28:45] Interviewer: What do those problems cost you?

[29:05] P01: "Time, mainly. And sometimes stress during audits or urgent buyer requests when information isn't where it should be."

[30:00] Interviewer: If you could change one thing to make starting a job easier, what would it be?

[30:30] P01: "A single, simple system that tells a new person exactly what to do in the first days, who to contact, and where key documents are instead of learning everything by trial and error."